25 – Capstone: My Personal AI Workflow Assistant

Definition: The **capstone** is the final project of the training: a documented, personal AI assistant with an optimized prompt library, safety concept and theoretical agent design – portfolio-worthy, in 2–4 hours.

> **Remember:** Reading 24 topics creates knowledge. Building your own project creates skill.

Key points

- **Prerequisite:** Final test passed – the capstone builds on all blocks.
- **Three phases:** Needs analysis (3 recurring tasks, prioritized) → prompt engineering (before/after, systematically tested) → safety & scaling (risk analysis, boundaries, agent-lite design).
- **Three deliverables:** Prompt library (10+ entries), agent-lite concept (theoretical), safety concept – plus a reflection note.
- **Grading:** Self-assessment with the capstone checklist, 24 points, pass mark 17. Safety criteria are hard (pass or 0).
- **Concept instead of code:** The agent stays a design – implementing it is the next stage after this training.
- **Duration:** 2–4 hours, spread across several days – one phase per day.

Example

Person A (fictional, administrative role) picks the **weekly report** in phase 1 (45 min./week). In phase 2 she improves the baseline prompt “Turn my notes into a report” in two rounds: role (“You write short status reports for management”), context (project names, fixed structure), constraints (max. 1 page, numbers only from the notes). In the test, the improved prompt saves about 25 minutes per report – the entry goes into the library with before/after and a test note. In phase 3 she sketches her agent-lite concept “report assistant” with approval before every send.

The complete sample (including grading) is in the example portfolio: `06_capstone/example_portfolio`.

Do / Don’t

Do	Don’t
Choose tasks you really repeat	Choose the flashiest or most complex task
Keep the before/after versions	Document only the finished prompts
Set boundaries and safety rules early	Paint safety on at the very end
Work with invented or anonymized data	Paste real customer data or records into prompts

Safety note

The capstone collects many of your prompts and workflows in one place. That makes the library itself something worth protecting: no sensitive content, secure storage, and before any new automation idea, run the risk analysis from phase 3 first.

Mini checklist

- ☐ I know that the final test is the gate to the capstone.
- ☐ I know the three phases and the three deliverables.
- ☐ I know that I grade it myself (checklist, 17/24 points).
- ☐ I know that the agent stays a concept and nothing gets implemented.

Exercise (5 min.)

Write down three recurring tasks from your everyday life and estimate for each: how often per week? How many minutes does it cost? Mark the one task you would take into your capstone first – and the reason.

Next

- Project instructions: `06_capstone/project_instructions`
- Self-assessment: `06_capstone/checklist`
- Sample for comparison: `06_capstone/example_portfolio`
- Related: 05 Prompt basics, 06 Prompt techniques, 16 Agents, 23 Everyday workflows

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